

Problem 4. Nganasan (20 marks)

Nganasan is a Uralic language spoken by the Nganasan people. Traditionally they have been the northernmost people in Eurasia, living in the Taimyr Peninsula, although today only around 470 Nganasan remain there, and fewer still speak the language.

Below are some Nganasan words written in a phonetic transcription, with their English translations given in alphabetical order. Note that **ð** = *th* in *this*, **d'** ≈ *j* in *judge*, **j** = *y* in *yes*; **č**, **ń**, **ŋ**, and **ʔ** are consonants; **ə**, **ü**, and **i** are vowels. Traditional Nganasan mythology includes several **ŋuəʔ** or gods, such as **bəndubtuə ŋuə** and **ńilitiə ŋuə**. The Nganasan people made small wooden idols, some of which would be kept in family homes, and offered them gifts to help please the gods.

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| 1. bad'ačimi | a. <i>aeroplane</i> |
| 2. bad'aʔbəbə | b. <i>boat</i> |
| 3. čimiʔ | c. <i>branches</i> |
| 4. d'üðübad'aʔ | d. <i>churches</i> |
| 5. d'üəbəbə | e. <i>earring</i> |
| 6. d'ütü | f. <i>gunpowder sack</i> |
| 7. huaad'ütüʔ | g. <i>hand</i> |
| 8. kojkəʔ | h. <i>hook</i> |
| 9. kojküʔmaðəʔ | i. <i>idols</i> |
| 10. koubasa | j. <i>purse</i> |
| 11. maðəʔ | k. <i>rings (for your fingers)</i> |
| 12. ŋənduj | l. <i>steamboats</i> |
| 13. təiriŋənduj | m. <i>stove</i> |
| 14. tuuŋəntuʔ | n. <i>teeth</i> |
| 15. tuusan | o. <i>tents</i> |

Q 4.1 Determine the correct correspondences between the words 1–15 and the words/phrases a–o.

Q 4.2 What is the literal translation of the Nganasan word **kojküʔmaðəʔ**?

Q 4.3 Translate into English:

16. **bəbəʔ**

17. **kojkə**

18. **kouʔ**

Q 4.4 Translate into Nganasan:

19. *boats*

20. *fires*

21. *(piece of) metal*

Q 4.5 Suggest a Nganasan translation of the phrase *forest fire*.